Family 2.0

By Walter Wykes

SUGGESTED ROLES:

Actor: *Husband, Son, First Husband/Dog*
Actress: *Wife, Daughter,*

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR: *How many times have we heard the cliche, "The grass is always greener on the other side?"*
ACTRESS: *While the overuse of this phrase has mostly dulled its impact, people who experience the "grass is greener syndrome" endure a significant struggle.*
ACTOR: *They truly believe that there is always something better what they have.*
ACTRESS: *Whether it's with relationships, careers, where they live, or their family, they always have one foot out the door.*
ACTOR: *Absurd?*
ACTRESS: *You have no idea!*
TOGETHER: *Meet Family 2.0 by Walter Wykes.*

A perfect-looking house-the kind you find in magazines. A perfect-looking wife puts the finishing touches on her perfect-looking living room. The front door opens and husband enters.

HUSBAND: Hi, Honey! I'm home!

WIFE: Who are you? What are you doing in my house?!

HUSBAND: I'm your new husband. Where should I put my coat? *[He tries to kiss wife; but she backs away from him terrified.]*

WIFE: Don't touch me! I'll scream! I'll call the police!

HUSBAND: Aren't you going to ask how my day was?

WIFE: *[Attempting to pacify him]* How ... how was your day?

HUSBAND: It was awful! Just like every other day! Same old boring job. Same old boring boss. Same old boring *life.* And then, on the way home, suddenly it hit to me -- why come home to the same old boring wife and house and kids and dog when I could try

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something new?

WIFE: But you can't just-

HUSBAND: I've always admired your home. It's very well kept.

WIFE: Thank you, but-

HUSBAND: I pass it every day on my way to work, so I thought today I'd give it a try. It has to be more exciting than the one I've been coming home to for the past fifteen years.

WIFE: But ... I already have a husband.

HUSBAND: He can have my life. Where does he work?

WIFE: He's an executive. At a technology company.

HUSBAND: Perfect! I love technology! All those little gadgets and stuff! It'll be great!

WIFE: Look, I'm ... I'm sorry your life is so boring. My life is boring too. But you can't just walk in here and expect us to-

HUSBAND: Oh! I almost forgot! I brought you flowers! *[He produces a bouquet of flowers from his coat.}*

WIFE: You brought me flowers?

HUSBAND: They're orchids-a symbol of rare beauty and eternal love-my love for you.

WIFE: My ... my husband hasn't brought me flowers in almost fifteen years.

HUSBAND: I wrote you a poem too.

WIFE: A poem?

HUSBAND: Would you like me to recite it?

WIFE: Well ... if you went to the trouble of writing it ... I ... I wouldn't want it to go to waste.

HUSBAND: You take my breath away. / Like the sunset or a summer day. / When I gaze at the moon / Or the ocean blue / They pale beside the sight of you. / You take my breath away.

WIFE: That's beautiful. You ... you really wrote that?

HUSBAND: For you. *[Pause. She considers this.]*

WIFE: Do you pee in the shower?

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HUSBAND: Never.

WIFE: Hog the sheets?

HUSBAND: Nope.

WIFE: Snore?

HUSBAND: I don't think so.

WIFE: Any history of baldness in your family?

HUSBAND: On the contrary. We're very hairy.

WIFE: Would you do your own laundry or wait for me to do it.

HUSBAND: Do it myself.

WIFE: Fix the toilet or call a plumber?

HUSBAND: Fix it.

WIFE: Shingle the roof or buy a new house?

HUSBAND: New house.

WIFE: Anniversary in Maui or Vegas?

HUSBAND: Maui.

WIFE: You'll have to win the kids over first. Children! *[Enter SON and DAUGHTER]* Children, meet your new father.

HUSBAND: Hi, kids.

SON: You're not my father! You're a fake! An imposter!

HUSBAND: Do you like baseball? I'll take you to the Big Game.

SON: The Big Game?! No way! *[He embraces husband] I* love you, Dad!

DAUGHTER: What about me? I hate baseball.

HUSBAND: Do you like shopping? Here-knock yourself out. *[He hands her a hundred-dollar bill.]*

DAUGHTER: A hundred-dollar bill?! You're the greatest! *[She kisses him on the cheek.}*

WIFE: Go play in your room, kids. Your father and I need some time alone. *[Exit kids.]* Now where were we? *[They kiss passionately. Enter FIRST HUSBAND]*

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FIRST HUSBAND: *[Entering]* Hi, Honey! I'm ... what's going on here?! What are you doing to my wife?! I'm calling the police!

WIFE: Wait! Give me your key.

FIRST HUSBAND: What?

WIFE: Your key. Hand it over.

FIRST HUSBAND: I don't understand.

WIFE: He's replacing you.

FIRST HUSBAND: *Replacing me?*

WIFE: That's right. He's in-you're out.

FIRST HUSBAND: But why?!

WIFE: He brought me flowers! When's the last time you brought me flowers?!

FIRST HUSBAND: *(Stammers)* I . . . I . . . I. . .

WIFE: Exactly. Now stop stuttering and hand over the key.

FIRST HUSBAND: But ... what about the kids?! You can't take the kids away from me! Kids! *[Enter SON and DAUGHTER]* You don't want me to go-do you kids?

SON: He's taking me to the Big Game.

FIRST HUSBAND: I'll take you!

SON: Too late. You had your chance.

DAUGHTER: Sorry. It's nothing personal.

WIFE: *[Her hand outstretched.]* The key.

FIRST HUSBAND: But I don't want to go! Please, I'll ... I'll do anything! Just let me stay! I won't bother you! I'll stay out of the way! I'll ... I'll be another kid! Or the family dog! [He assumes the character of a dog, wags his tail, barks]

SON: I've always wanted a dog! Please?! Can I keep him?! Can I?!

WIFE: I don't know. What do you think, Honey?

HUSBAND: He'd be your responsibility, son. We're not going to feed him for you, or take him for walks, or clean up his poop-

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SON: I'll take care of him! I promise! *[To DOG]* Come here, boy! Sit! Roll over! Play dead! Good boy! *[Dog follows all commands barking excessively]*

DAUGHTER: Can I go shopping now? *(She is ignored)*

FIRST HUSBAND/DOG: Woof! Woof!

WIFE: I think the dog has to go.

HUSBAND: Son, take your dog outside.

SON: I can't. I have homework. *[Exit son]*

DAUGHTER: Can I go shopping or not? *(she is ignored again)*

FIRST HUSBAND/DOG: Woof! Woof!

WIFE: Honey, could you take care of the dog? *(reproachfully)* You told him he could keep it.

HUSBAND: Do we have a leash?

DAUGHTER: Is anybody listening to me? *[Enter son with baseball and glove.]*

SON: Hey Dad, can we play ball?

HUSBAND: I thought you had homework.

SON: I just finished.

HUSBAND: *[To son]* Here-take the dog outside.

SON: I have to poop. *[Exit son]*

DAUGHTER: *Hello?* I hate this family!

WIFE: *[To husband}* While you're out, can you take the trash? And could you do something about your daughter?

HUSBAND: What do you want me to-

FIRST HUSBAND/DOG: Woof! Woof!

HUSBAND: *[To Dog]* Shut up, you stupid mutt! *(Dog continues barking and spinning in circles)*

WIFE: I think he really wants to go.

DAUGHTER: What about me?! Does anybody care what I want?! *[Enter son}*

SON: The Big Game starts any minute! We have to go!

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HUSBAND: *[To wife]* When ... when we get back it would be really nice to have some quality *alone time* if you know what I mean.

WIFE: It'll have to wait, Dear. You have responsibilities now.

HUSBAND: Responsibilities?! This isn't what I signed up for! You're just like my first wife!

WIFE: *WHAT* did you say?!!!

SON: We're gonna miss the game! We have to go NOW! You promised!

DAUGHTER: I asked first! It's not fair! You can't just ignore me!

FIRST HUSBAND/DOG: Woof!

As the cacophony rises, everyone converges on HUSBAN.D They surround him like a pack of rabid wolves.

WIFE: Are you hearing me?! Are we clear on this?! It's gonna take a LOT to make up for this little slip-up, Mister!

SON: All I wanted to do was go to the Big Game! But now it's too late! I already told all of my friends we were going, and they're all going to know what losers we are!

DAUGHTER: Am I invisible? Am I not even here? What do I have to do to get some attention in this house?!

FIRST HUSBAND/DOG: Woof! Woof!

HUSBAND: I NEED A NEW LIFE!!!

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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